



MyGurukul

SACRED WISDOM — SATURDAY, FEBRUARY 14, 2026



SACRED TEXT

*bhūmir āpo 'nalo vāyuh khaṁ mano buddhir eva ca |
ahaṁkāra itīyaṁ me bhinnā prakṛtir aṣṭadhā ||4||*

— Bhagavadgītā-4comm with the commentaries of Śrīdhara, Madhusūdana, Viśvanātha and Baladeva, Chapter 1, Verse

4

GURU'S INTERPRETATION

These are the foundational elements from which the entire manifested world arises: earth, water, fire, air, ether (or space), mind, intellect, and ego. Consider this not just as a scientific explanation, but as a profound spiritual mapping of your own inner landscape.

Earth represents solidity, structure, and stability – the groundedness you feel when connected to nature or rooted in your values. Water signifies fluidity, adaptability, and emotions – the ever-changing currents of your feelings and desires. Fire embodies energy, transformation, and passion – the driving force behind your actions and ambitions. Air represents movement, communication, and connection – the breath that sustains you and the thoughts that fill your mind. Ether is space itself, the canvas upon which everything else unfolds – the awareness that allows you to perceive and experience.

Beyond the physical elements, Krishna moves into the subtle realms of mind, intellect, and ego. The mind is the seat of thoughts and perceptions, constantly processing information. The intellect is the faculty of reason and discernment, allowing you to distinguish between right and wrong, truth and falsehood. The ego is the sense of "I," the individual identity that separates you from the universal consciousness.

Understanding these eight aspects of prakṛiti allows you to gain mastery over your own internal world. By recognizing the interplay of these elements within yourself, you can learn to balance your emotions, focus your mind, and transcend the limitations of your ego. In modern life, this understanding is invaluable. When you feel overwhelmed by stress, you can reconnect with the earth element through grounding practices. When you struggle with difficult emotions, you can embrace the fluidity of water. When you lack motivation, you can ignite the fire within. Ultimately, by recognizing these elements as manifestations of Krishna's lower nature, you can begin to perceive the divine presence in all things.

REFLECTION FOR TODAY

How can you consciously engage with each of these eight elements within yourself to cultivate greater balance and self-awareness in your daily life?